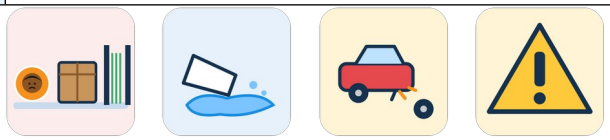
02 · Lesson spec

What is a Problem? · 40 minutes · whole class, then groups of 4–6 · fully unplugged

Goal	**I can say what the problem is.**
Core parts	Move + Code
Key words	problem · stuck · help · solve · safe
Materials	Cut-out Ayo; a big light box; taped path to a “school gate”; problem picture cards (Printables), one set per group; an empty cup and a shoe with laces for acting



1. Watch (5 min)

- **Welcome to Term 3!** “This term we are **problem solvers**. We will use our steps and our patterns to solve small problems.”
- **Show:** cut-out Ayo walks along the path… and stops at a big box. “Oh no! Ayo is **stuck**. What is the problem?”
- Take answers. Model the sentence: “**The problem is** the box is in the way.” Ask: “How do we know it is a problem?” (Ayo can’t do what he wants to do.)
- **Hand signs:** problem = hands on cheeks, “oh no” face · stuck = feet together, can’t move · help = one hand lifts the other · solve = thumbs up · safe = arms hug yourself.

2. Do in groups (25 min)

a) Problem acting, whole class (10 min) · Core: Move

- A child (or the teacher) acts a small problem: shoelace undone, door shut, water spilled (empty cup). The class says: “The problem is…”
- Swap actors. Keep it playful: “Oh no!” faces and big gestures.

b) Problem spotters, groups (10 min) · Core: Code

- Each group gets 4 problem picture cards: blocked path, spilled water, broken toy, danger sign. Children **point to what is wrong** and say each problem.
- Mix in “no problem” cards (clear path, full cup, whole toy car). “Is there a problem here? How do you know?”
- **Danger sign:** “What do we do?” → **stop, step back and tell a grown-up.**
- **Stretch:** say two ways to solve Ayo’s box problem (go around it; ask a friend to help move it).

c) Activity Book page (5 min)

- Circle the problem in each picture. Not marked.

3. Share (10 min)

- **Create:** draw a time you had a problem and who helped you.
- Optional Build: put a box “wall” on the grid and make Ayo stuck. Next week we will start solving it.
- **Close:** “Problem solvers first say what the problem is. Then we find a way to solve it.”

Common mistakes

- Saying the solution before the problem (“Move the box!”) → “Great idea! But first: what **is** the problem?”
- Describing the picture without the problem (“a cup”) → “What is wrong? What can’t we do?”

What if it doesn’t work?

- Children are shy to act → the teacher acts; children say the problem.
- No picture cards → use real objects: a closed door, an empty cup on its side, a toy with a part off.

Support and stretch

- **Support:** give the sentence starter “The problem is…” and point to the wrong part together.
- **Stretch** (optional, never assessed): say two ways to solve Ayo’s problem.

How we check

Observation only. Tick each child who **says what Ayo’s problem is**.

> **Safety**
> Spills acted with an empty cup (or a little water over a tray, with an adult). The box is light and empty. Danger sign = stop, step back, tell a grown-up.